

Off the Clock

A Vision Design Document

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Vision

Pitch

What role will your player enact and what challenge or situation do they find themselves in? For example: "You are a father who is secretly an octopus"

1. You are an overworked Mathematics teacher who is secretly a mecha pilot fighter in another world. They will need to switch between their lives to manage both roles at the same time.

World

What kind of world is the action set in? For example: "high fantasy", "space opera", "Victorian murder mystery", etc.

1. There will be two worlds occurring in parallel:
 - a. The first world is "reality", specifically a teacher's office
 - b. The second world is one of science fiction, specifically a flight over otherworldly land masses while battling enemies as a mecha

Genre

What type of mechanics does the player play? For example: "puzzle", "rhythm game", "first-person shooter", etc.

1. There will be two primary mechanics depending on which world the player is in:
 - a. First “real” world: Grading exams (i.e. “puzzle”) under time pressure, where the player’s performance is dictated by the accuracy to the deserved grade.
 - b. Second science fiction world: First-person shooter from inside a cockpit
2. The player can switch between these two worlds and mechanics
3. There is also an overarching mechanic of balancing the two worlds
 - a. You lose if you don’t grade papers quickly, or kill enough enemies before they defeat your mecha

Inspirations

What art, stories, or other games are you copying from?

1. The concept of having two worlds (and thus two very different roles) and transitioning between them is derived from:
 - a. Hazelight Studios’s *Split Fiction* (2025)
 - b. James Cameron’s *Avatar* (2009)
 - c. The magical girl anime genre
2. Further, the concept of having two different art styles for two different worlds is taken from:
 - a. *Hello World* (2019) – one world is in CGI and the other is in 2D
 - b. *The Wizard of Oz* (1939)
3. The grading papers mechanic is taken from:
 - a. Talha’s life...
 - b. *Overcooked!* (2016): the time mechanic
4. The mecha first-person shooter mechanic is inspired by:
 - a. Yoshiyuki Tomino’s Gundam media franchise
 - b. Square Enix’s *Kingdom Hearts III* (2019): mecha fighting sequence in the Toy Story world
 - c. Square Enix’s *NieR:Automata* (2017): mecha piloting and fighting sequence in the game’s introduction
 - d. Monolithsoft’s *Xenoblade Chronicles X* (2015): Skells and flying around/ fighting in them

Mechanics

Required Mechanics

What interactions or game rules (known as "mechanics") does your game need to be playable? List one mechanic per team member in your group

1. Shanmukh Upadhyayula: Mecha battle system. The player will control a mecha suit with arms that can hold weapons and move around to battle enemies that are attacking them.
2. Talha Coskun: Grading paper system. Random Mathematics questions of varying complexity will be generated, each of which have a limited amount of time to be graded via player interaction.
3. Mireille Tan: Interworld coordination system. The player will be able to teleport between the two worlds running in parallel; if they hit either one of the lose conditions (from each world), the player loses the entire game.
4. Aimee Zhang: Economy system. Money earned from the player's job as a Mathematics teacher (based on the number of papers graded) can be spent on new upgrades for the mecha, such as improved weapon stats.

Core Loop Schedule

Half of your mechanics should be things your player interacts with constantly in the game, forming the fundamental "core loop" fun of your game. List which of your Required Mechanics are in the Core Loop. List them in the order your player will first encounter them in for your tutorial. If they would appear near the same time, think about which you'd explain first to a new player.

1. Grading papers: The game starts with the player in a teacher's office environment with a stack of papers in front of them and a stamp in their hand. The paper on top has a Mathematics question on it, with two checkboxes – one with a cross and one with a check mark. Juicy feedback will kick in once the player pokes one of the checkboxes to indicate if they graded the paper correctly or not. This will repeat for several more papers.

2. Interworld coordination: Afterwards, a button appears with a view of the sci-fi world. The glow of the button draws the player to interact with it, and by hovering their hand over it for some time, they are transported to the sci-fi world with a cockpit in a mecha suit. The teleporter button also appears in the aforementioned cockpit, but with a view of the original office.
3. Mecha battle: The mecha suit will automatically be holding a gun and a sword, with prompts from the cockpit telling the player how to use them. After a few seconds, enemies will appear and move towards the player from a distance, who can be defeated by the player's attacks.

Meta Loop Schedule

The other half of your mechanics should be things that ramp up the excitement of the game the longer the player plays. In the Beat Saber example, new levels with different block spawning patterns would be a Meta Loop mechanic. You should list them in the order your player will encounter them in the ramp up.

1. Economy: Whenever the player grades a paper successfully, particle effects and a UI will indicate them earning money. In the mecha world, this UI element will persist showing how much money the user has, and there will be a panel showing different weapons (and their stats) and their cost. The player can spend the money they have to change their mecha's weapons.

Summary

Conclude the document with a section marked "Summary" and write a paragraph describing the game you will make and the player's experience.

1. Our game is a split-life game where you play an overworked Mathematics teacher who is also secretly a mecha pilot. The player is stuck balancing two parallel worlds: one is a mundane office where you have to manually grade exams to earn their paycheck, and the other is a stylized sci-fi world where they're fighting enemies in a mecha. They only get a certain amount of time in each world, so they're forced to switch back and forth. If they don't grade enough

exams, they don't earn enough money to upgrade their mech. If they slack off in the mecha, they will get overwhelmed with enemies, eventually causing their health to drop down to zero. Ultimately, it's a game about balance, that juxtaposes the stressful yet mundane aspects of everyday work with the power they feel while piloting a mecha suit – especially as they gain some juicy new upgrades!